the army in particular, and the ripple effect has been felt by the navy and the air force too.

We have had two cases in the past where extremely competent, highly decorated and meritorious generals were superseded in the race for the chief's appointment – Lieutenant Generals P.S. Bhagat, the only Indian officer who was awarded the Victoria Cross during the Second World War, and S.K. Sinha, vice chief of the army. But both of them accepted the decision of the government with dignity and grace and decided to fade away. They are held in high esteem and remembered even today. Perhaps we ought to learn a few things also from our civil service colleagues.

On completion of my tenure as the CO of 5th (Royal) Maratha LI and of the 9th before that, my wish on being commissioned as a second lieutenant was fulfilled – what more could one ask for. 'Anything else that comes my way now shall be a bonus,' is what I said to myself as described in Part II. Many of us have got much more, but happiness? I'm not sure.

> Many are those who see others' faults;
> There are some who see their virtues as well,
> Of those who can see their own faults,
> Alas: their number is very small.

In our context, there can be no better example of an officer and a gentleman and a charismatic leader than Field Marshal Sam Manekshaw. At the highest levels of military leadership, one is required to have the moral courage to call a spade a spade and to render professional advice keeping national interest uppermost. Not only was General Manekshaw gifted with this important quality, but he was also endowed with the ability to put across his views tactfully and effectively. The manner in which he displayed these attributes in early 1971, when the occasion demanded, during the briefing and discussions regarding the Bangladesh war, is legendary. A lesser person would not have been able to do what Sam Bahadur did. Sam also lived life fully. He was disarming and friendly. Endowed with social charm and grace, he was an extremely popular